WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

JORDAN

Middle East

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Amman	Capital and main commercial centre; seat of government and hub for banking, ICT and professional services	Financial services, ICT, pharmaceuticals, healthcare
Aqaba Special Economic Zone (Red Sea)	Jordan's only seaport and a fast-growing regional transit gateway; transit containers rose 160.8% in January–July 2026, with Iraq-bound volumes up more than tenfold	Port logistics, transit trade, tourism, industry
Aqaba–Amman National Water Carrier corridor	Route of the 300 million m^3-a-year desalination and 450 km conveyance PPP, with a 280MW solar plant at Al-Quweira; construction is expected to start in Q4 2026	Water infrastructure, renewable energy, engineering services
Shidiya (phosphate) and Ghor Al Safi (potash)	Core mining areas for a country with the world's second-largest phosphate reserves, to be linked to Aqaba by the planned 360 km, $2.3 billion UAE–Jordan railway	Mining, fertilisers, rail freight
Zarqa Free Zone, King Hussein Business Park and development zones	Zones allowing full foreign ownership with tax and customs incentives for export and transit activity	Manufacturing, logistics, business services
Northern and eastern border crossings (Jaber to Syria; Karama–Trebil to Iraq)	Overland gateways to two recovering neighbours; trucks through Karama–Trebil rose 131% in January–July 2026 and trade with Syria nearly trebled in 2025	Cross-border trade, construction materials, logistics
Petra, Wadi Rum and the Dead Sea	World-class heritage and leisure destinations that drew more than 7 million visitors in 2025	Tourism, hospitality, wellness

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Ministry of Investment, the main reference authority for investors, offering a Comprehensive Investment Service through a joint electronic licensing platform; official entities must decide within 15 working days or the application is deemed approved
- Investment Environment Law of 2022 guaranteeing equal treatment of Jordanian and foreign investors, protection against expropriation without fair market compensation, and arbitration under UNCITRAL or ICC rules where contracts allow

- Incentives under the same law, including customs exemptions on fixed assets and inputs, income-tax reductions of at least 30% for projects in less-developed regions or employing 250+ Jordanians, and seven-year protection from adverse legal changes for projects of JD5 million or more
- Aqaba Special Economic Zone, administered by ASEZA with the Aqaba Development Corporation as master developer, offering 100% foreign ownership and port and logistics concessions
- Development and free zones (including King Hussein Business Park and Zarqa Free Zone) with no foreign-capital limits and tax and customs exemptions for export and transit activity
- Dinar pegged to the US dollar under Central Bank of Jordan oversight, with the law guaranteeing conversion and transfer of funds in and out of the Kingdom without delay
- Public-private partnerships and joint ventures with state-linked partners such as Jordan Phosphate Mines, Arab Potash and the Social Security Investment Fund, as used for the National Water Carrier and the Aqaba railway

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Jordan in October 2026 offers a stable, reform-minded economy that is gaining momentum. Real GDP grew 2.8% in 2025 and accelerated to 2.9% in Q1 and 3.0% in Q2 2026, with agriculture (+7.8%) and manufacturing (+6.2%) leading, while inflation remains low at 2.0% in the first half of 2026. Foreign direct investment rose 25.1% to $2.02 billion in 2025, the highest since 2017, with Gulf investors providing almost a third, and national exports grew 9.9% to JD9.6 billion. The IMF completed the fifth review of Jordan's Extended Fund Facility in June 2026, noting that all end-2025 quantitative targets were met, and S&P affirmed Jordan at BB- with a stable outlook in August 2026. The Economic Modernisation Vision has entered its second phase (2026–2029), backed by the 2022 Investment Environment Law and a €3 billion EU package for 2025–2027.

Jordan's main structural challenge is its reliance on imported energy, which meets around 96% of needs, alongside chronic water scarcity and exposure to regional events. Both were tested from late February 2026, when the Iran war briefly halted Israeli gas supplies and slowed tourism. Jordan responded quickly: backup fuels kept power flowing, gas supply has since resumed, the Central Bank introduced a JD760 million liquidity and sector-support package, and the IMF expects the economic impact to remain limited. Reserves stood at $26.1 billion at end-June 2026, covering 8.6 months of imports. The disruption has also highlighted Jordan's strategic value: as Gulf trade rerouted, Aqaba's transit container traffic rose 160.8% in January–July 2026. Long-term solutions are now moving into delivery, notably the National Water Carrier, a $5.8 billion desalination PPP backed by $1.8 billion from the US DFC, which is expected to supply about 40% of drinking water from 2030, and the $2.3 billion UAE–Jordan railway to Aqaba.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Regional security developments	The 2026 Iran war brought missile and drone activity over Jordan, most of it intercepted, and temporarily weighed on tourism and import costs	Jordan's strong security partnerships and rapid policy response contained the impact; investors can build short-disruption scenarios into planning and benefit from Aqaba's growing role as a rerouting hub
Energy import dependence	Jordan imports around 96% of its energy, and the early-2026 gas interruption raised power-generation costs by about $140 million a month	Gas supply has resumed and backup fuel arrangements proved effective; the reliance creates openings in solar, storage and green ammonia projects
Water scarcity	Limited water resources constrain agriculture and industrial expansion and weigh on investor planning	The National Water Carrier will add 300 million m³ a year from 2030, opening opportunities in water technology, engineering and efficiency services
Public debt	Public debt stood at 84% of GDP excluding Social Security holdings in mid-2026	Fiscal performance has exceeded IMF programme targets and the government aims to reduce debt to around 80% of GDP by end-2028
Labour-market slack	Unemployment eased to 16.1% in Q2 2026 (21.0% among Jordanians)	Investors gain access to an available, English-proficient, college-educated

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
		workforce, particularly in engineering and ICT, and to employment-linked tax incentives
Administrative procedures	Bureaucratic processes have historically slowed approvals and licensing	Use the Ministry of Investment's electronic one-stop service, with its 15-working-day deemed-approval rule and investor grievance committee
Tourism sensitivity to regional sentiment	Tourism receipts were 5.3% lower in H1 2026, although June receipts rose 7.0%	International promotion campaigns are underway; recovery offers entry points in hospitality at Petra, Wadi Rum, the Dead Sea and Aqaba

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Jordan's risk profile is that of a well-managed, stable economy in a complex neighbourhood. Its macroeconomic anchors are strong: a long-standing dollar peg backed by $26.1 billion of reserves, low inflation, an IMF programme on track through five consecutive reviews, and a stable BB- rating from S&P. The 2026 regional conflict tested the economy through energy, tourism and trade channels, and the response — alternative fuels, targeted Central Bank support and continued fiscal discipline — kept growth rising to 3.0% in Q2 2026. Reduced US development aid has been partly offset by a new $354 million four-year US agreement and the EU's €3 billion package. Investors should plan for periodic regional volatility, but can take confidence from Jordan's institutional continuity, deep international partnerships and the investor protections of the 2022 Investment Environment Law.

MARKET ACCESS

Jordan combines preferential access to Western and Arab markets. Its free trade agreement with the United States was reinforced by a July 2026 reciprocal trade agreement capping tariffs at 10% and setting zero tariffs on apparel and textiles, Jordan's largest export sector; exports to the US exceeded $800 million in Q1 2026. The EU–Jordan Strategic and Comprehensive Partnership, signed in January 2025, underpins preferential EU access, and exports to the EU rose 39.3% in 2025. Membership of the Greater Arab Free Trade Area gives tariff-free access to Saudi Arabia and other Arab markets, while Syria is re-emerging as a market, with bilateral trade rising to JD334 million in 2025 from JD116 million in 2024. Aqaba links Jordan to Red Sea shipping, and overland routes to Iraq and Syria, together with the planned national rail network, position the Kingdom as a logistics gateway for the Levant and Iraq.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Royal Hashemite Court (King Abdullah II)	Sets national strategic direction and sponsors the Economic Modernisation Vision, now in its 2026–2029 phase	Primary reference point for Jordan's long-term economic and partnership priorities
Prime Ministry and Investment Council (PM Jaafar Hassan)	The Council, chaired by the Prime Minister, approves investment policy and priority sectors and can grant single approvals for strategic projects	Key forum for strategic-project status and cross-government issues
Ministry of Investment (Minister Tareq Abu Ghazaleh)	Main investor authority; runs the one-stop licensing platform, incentives and the investment opportunities map	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentive guidance
Central Bank of Jordan	Maintains the dinar's dollar peg and sets the policy rate, held at 5.75% in July 2026	Relevant for currency, banking and financing matters
Aqaba Special Economic Zone Authority (ASEZA) and Aqaba Development Corporation	Regulator and master developer of the Aqaba zone and its ports, including the 30-year multipurpose port concession with AD Ports Group	Essential partners for logistics, port, industrial and tourism investment in Aqaba
Ministry of Water and Irrigation	Contracting authority for the National	Key counterpart for water, desalination

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	Water Carrier PPP with Meridiam and Suez	and related supply-chain opportunities
Jordan Phosphate Mines Co. and Arab Potash Co.	Leading mining and fertiliser exporters and shareholders in the UAE–Jordan railway joint venture	Natural partners for mining, processing and logistics investment
Social Security Investment Fund	Social security investment arm and co-investor in the National Water Carrier and the Aqaba railway	Potential local co-investor for large infrastructure and PPP projects

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce in Jordan and the Amman Chamber of Industry are well-established channels for business liaison, and the Jordan–EU Investment Conference of April 2026 was designed as a platform for flagship infrastructure and connectivity deals. Development finance is deep and active: the EBRD invested €201 million across ten projects in Jordan in 2025, mostly in the private sector, under its 2025–2030 country strategy, while the World Bank Group, EIB, Islamic Development Bank, Proparco, JICA, the OPEC Fund and the US DFC are all financing the National Water Carrier. The EU's €3 billion package for 2025–2027 and Gulf investors, notably from the UAE and Saudi Arabia, provide further co-financing and partnership routes.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Jordan suits investors seeking a stable, well-connected base for the Levant, Iraq and the Gulf: logistics and transport investors positioned around Aqaba and the planned rail network; infrastructure, water and renewable-energy investors drawn by large, DFI-backed PPPs; manufacturers in apparel, pharmaceuticals, food and chemicals benefiting from US, EU and Arab market access and development-zone incentives; mining and fertiliser investors building on world-class phosphate and potash resources; and ICT and services investors seeking an English-speaking, skilled workforce. Construction-materials and trading firms can also use Jordan as a platform for Syria's and Iraq's reconstruction demand.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage the Ministry of Investment and confirm incentive eligibility
Use the one-stop electronic service to scope licensing, tax and customs incentives, and legal-stability protection under the 2022 Investment Environment Law.

STEP 2: Select the right zone or structure
Compare the Aqaba Special Economic Zone, development zones and free zones for ownership, tax treatment and market-access requirements.

STEP 3: Position for the infrastructure pipeline
Track supply-chain and co-investment opportunities around the National Water Carrier, the UAE–Jordan railway and Aqaba port expansion as they move into construction.

STEP 4: Build regional-disruption scenarios into planning
Draw on the 2026 experience, when energy supply, trade and tourism recovered quickly, to set practical contingencies for supply chains and energy costs.

STEP 5: Partner with development finance and local institutions
Explore co-financing with the EBRD, EU and other DFIs and local co-investors such as the Social Security Investment Fund to strengthen project bankability.